

MY VILLA

ITALIAN SOUL · CALIFORNIAN BODY

A new design-led model for fire-resilient luxury homes in Los Angeles



PRESS KIT

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Press Summary

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MyVilla Launches in Los Angeles with Fire-Resilient Luxury Villas Built in Italian Reinforced Concrete

MyVilla is a new design-led company offering custom luxury villas in Los Angeles, built entirely in double-skin precast reinforced concrete — a construction system widely used across European residential architecture but virtually absent from the California market.

The company brings together a curated team of European architects, climate engineers, structural specialists and artisan concrete builders, working with California-based delivery partners to create highly customized villas for the Los Angeles luxury market.

The launch collection introduces four architectural typologies — Courtyard House, L House, Deconstructed House, and Hill House — each designed by IT'S Architecture (Rome/Geneva/Paris) and fully engineered for California permitting, seismic code, and fire-resilient construction. Target price point is \$15M+ per villa, with a fixed-price, approximately 20-month delivery from briefing to move-in.

MyVilla enters the market at a moment of heightened attention to residential fire resilience in Southern California, following the January 2025 Palisades Fire which destroyed over 6,800 structures — the vast majority built in wood frame. The company's reinforced concrete system offers a non-combustible structural alternative with potential insurance, durability and maintenance advantages.

KEY FACTS

What	Custom luxury villas in reinforced concrete, from \$15M+
Where	Los Angeles — Pacific Palisades, Beverly Hills, Bel Air, Brentwood, Malibu
Who	Founded by Paolo Mezzalama, architect, co-founder IT'S Architecture
Team	IT'S Architecture, Transsolar KlimaEngineering, BUROMILAN, DGU
Timeline	Approximately 20 months from briefing to move-in
Status	Press outreach launched March 2026

AVAILABLE FOR PRESS

- Founder and design team available for interview
- 12 high-resolution architectural renders
- Founder portrait (high-res)

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Why It Matters

In Rome, Paris, and Milan, reinforced concrete and masonry have been the default for residential construction for over a century. From seismic zones in Southern Italy to Mediterranean coastlines in France, European homes are built to endure — in materials that do not ignite, do not degrade, and require minimal structural maintenance.

In the United States, 94% of single-family homes are still built in wood frame — including in designated wildfire zones.

THE WOOD-FRAME PARADOX

California follows the national trend: wood-frame construction (classified as Type V by building codes) remains the dominant method for residential buildings, even in areas designated as Very High Fire Hazard Severity Zones. The state's building code still permits combustible structural materials for homes up to four stories.

The January 2025 Palisades Fire alone destroyed over 6,800 structures — the vast majority of them wood-frame homes. Today, more than a year later, reconstruction is underway and the permitting process is accelerating. Yet most homeowners are rebuilding with the same materials. Only about 5% of new homes nationwide use concrete.

My Villa exists to offer a different path: the European standard, engineered for California.

THE INSURANCE QUESTION

The California homeowner insurance market has contracted significantly since 2022. Several of the state's largest insurers have restricted new policies in fire-prone areas, with State Farm and Allstate among those that have stopped writing new homeowner policies in California. For owners of luxury properties in hillside and coastal neighborhoods, securing adequate coverage has become a growing challenge.

California's regulatory framework explicitly links verified wildfire-mitigation measures to insurance discounts, with the direction of regulation toward stronger recognition of mitigation in underwriting and pricing. Non-combustible construction may meaningfully improve the insurability profile of homes in high-risk areas.

THE COST EQUATION

Building in reinforced concrete typically costs in the order of 10–15% more than an equivalent wood-frame structure, depending on design and market conditions. That premium should be weighed against lower insurance costs, significantly reduced exterior maintenance — no repainting, no recladding, no termite treatment — and a structural lifespan estimated at two to three times longer than wood frame.

The Vision

My Villa designs and orchestrates fire-resilient luxury villas in Los Angeles, combining Italian architectural heritage with California's most demanding construction standards. Each home is built in double-skin precast reinforced concrete — a non-combustible system engineered for longevity, seismic performance and thermal comfort.

MyVilla brings together a curated team of European architects, engineers and concrete specialists, working with California-based delivery partners to create highly customized villas for the Los Angeles market. The client receives a fully integrated, fixed-price delivery from briefing to move-in in approximately 20 months.

WHY LOS ANGELES, WHY NOW

The January 2025 Palisades Fire destroyed over 6,800 structures across Pacific Palisades and Malibu, underscoring the vulnerability of wood-frame construction in wildfire zones. A multi-year rebuild cycle is underway in some of LA's most valuable coastal neighborhoods. My Villa offers a proven alternative: homes built in the same reinforced concrete technology used in European museums and cultural landmarks. Greater Los Angeles recorded 499 single-family home sales above \$10M in 2024, with volume tracking approximately 20% higher year-over-year in 2025.

AT A GLANCE

Target market custom luxury villas from \$15M+

Delivery integrated design-to-delivery coordination

Timeline approximately 20 months from briefing to move-in

Collection four pre-engineered typologies, adaptable to site and client



Villa Collection

The launch collection introduces four architectural starting points for the California market, each designed by IT'S Architecture and fully engineered for California permitting, seismic code, and fire-resilient construction. Every typology is adaptable to site, lifestyle and permitting conditions.



COURTYARD HOUSE

Open-plan villa centered around a private courtyard



L HOUSE

L-shaped villa maximizing garden views and natural light



DECONSTRUCTED HOUSE

Modular villa with interconnected pavilions



HILL HOUSE

Elevated villa for sloped terrain with panoramic views

Construction Technology

Every My Villa home is built using a double-skin precast reinforced concrete wall system — the same construction technology used in Palazzo Grassi and the Kimbell Art Museum. This is a non-combustible building system that provides high fire resistance, seismic resilience, and thermal performance.

THE WALL SYSTEM

Outer layer

Architectural-grade exposed concrete with oxide pigments — no paint, no cladding.

Insulation

100mm continuous thermal insulation layer for passive climate performance.

Inner layer

55mm reinforced structural concrete core with welded mesh and steel girders.

Total thickness

Approximately 250mm — a non-combustible monolithic envelope.

WHY THIS MATTERS TO EDITORS

- Fire resistance** Non-combustible structural system (reinforced concrete vs. wood-frame)
- Seismic performance** Monolithic concrete engineered for California seismic code
- Thermal performance** Continuous insulation + bioclimatic design by Transsolar
- Acoustic comfort** 250mm concrete envelope provides high acoustic isolation
- Lower maintenance** Concrete exterior requires significantly less maintenance over time



Resilience by Design

Fire resistance is only the beginning. Every My Villa home is designed as a self-sufficient system — engineered to perform independently of the grid, to maintain comfort with reduced mechanical reliance, and to protect its inhabitants not just from fire, but from the infrastructure disruptions that follow.

100%

Electric
Zero Gas

80%

Solar-Powered
Electricity

2–3 Days

Off-Grid
Autonomy

250mm

Reinforced
Concrete Walls

ENERGY INDEPENDENCE

Integrated photovoltaic panels are designed to cover approximately 80% of the home's electricity needs and 20% of hot water. Battery storage provides backup power during grid outages — a meaningful advantage in a region where wildfires can trigger blackouts affecting hundreds of thousands of households. The system runs entirely on electricity, with no gas line or combustible fuel stored on the property.

OFF-GRID AUTONOMY

Each villa is designed to operate independently for two to three days without external utilities. Rainwater harvesting addresses drought conditions. Solar generation paired with battery storage maintains essential systems during extended outages. The goal is to make the home more resilient during utility disruptions and post-fire infrastructure challenges.

NATURAL MICROCLIMATE

Transsolar's bioclimatic engineering shapes every volume and opening. Cross-ventilation is calibrated to Los Angeles's prevailing west-to-east breezes. Taller ceilings on the southern exposure provide optimal shading. The exposed concrete acts as thermal mass — absorbing heat during the day and releasing it at night. Green roofs add a layer of natural insulation. The design reduces reliance on mechanical cooling through thermal mass, shading and cross-ventilation.



The Team

MyVilla's model is built around a pre-assembled international team: Italian architecture, German climate engineering, Italian structural design and specialist concrete expertise with California production capability.

FOUNDER

Paolo Mezzalama is an architect and co-founder of IT'S Architecture, the Rome–Geneva–Paris practice leading the architectural design of the My Villa collection. With MyVilla, he brings together European design culture and a California-specific response to wildfire risk, resilience, and long-term residential value.

Mezzalama graduated from Roma Tre Faculty of Architecture in 2001. In 2004 he co-founded the Scape group, awarded the Nouveaux Albums des Jeunes Architectes by the French Ministry of Culture in 2008. In 2014 his practice received the Young Talent of Italian Architecture award (CNAPPC). He co-founded IT'S s.r.l. in 2016 with Alessandro Cambi and Francesco Marinelli.

IN HIS WORDS

“MyVilla was born from a simple question: why should California rebuild tomorrow with the same logic that failed yesterday?”

— on the founding vision

“We are bringing to Los Angeles a European idea of permanence — homes designed not only to look beautiful, but to endure.”

— on design philosophy

“In our view, true luxury is not excess. It is resilience, comfort, precision and the confidence that a home will last.”

— on contemporary luxury

PARTNERS

IT'S Architecture Rome · Geneva · Paris

Architecture & Design

Transsolar KlimaEngineering Stuttgart · New York

Climate Engineering

BUROMILAN Milan · Venice

Structural Engineering

DGU Treviso · Los Angeles

Architectural Concrete

Key Facts

Company	My Villa — Design-Led Luxury Villa Orchestrator
Tagline	Italian Soul, Californian Body
Location	Los Angeles, CA (Pacific Palisades, Beverly Hills, Bel Air, Brentwood, Malibu)
Founded	2024
Target	Ultra-luxury custom villas, \$15M+
Delivery	Fixed-price, ~20-month integrated delivery from briefing to move-in
Construction	Double-skin precast reinforced concrete — non-combustible, seismic-grade
Collection	4 typologies: Courtyard, L House, Deconstructed, Hill House
Design team	IT'S (Rome/Geneva/Paris), Transsolar (Stuttgart/NY), BUROMILAN (Milan), DGU (Treviso/LA)
Founder	Paolo Mezzalama — architect, co-founder IT'S Architecture
Website	myvilla.la
Languages	English, Italian

MEDIA ASSETS AVAILABLE

- 12 high-resolution architectural renders (JPEG, print-ready)
- 3 brand logos (SVG — Wordmark, Arch Palm, Monogram)
- Founder portrait — Paolo Mezzalama (JPEG, 1200×1600)

MEDIA CONTACT

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myvilla.la

Founder and design team available for interview upon request.

Story Angles for Editors

The following editorial angles may be of interest. MyVilla's founder and design team are available for interviews, background briefings and site commentary.

The post-wildfire future of luxury housing in Los Angeles

How is the Palisades Fire reshaping expectations around residential construction in LA's highest-value neighborhoods? What alternatives to wood-frame are emerging, and what barriers remain?

European concrete culture meets the American wood-frame norm

Why does the United States still build the vast majority of its homes in wood — even in fire and seismic zones — while Europe defaulted to concrete and masonry generations ago? What would it take for California to shift?

Italian design entering California residential luxury

A Rome-based architecture studio, a Stuttgart climate engineering firm, and a Venetian concrete builder walk into Los Angeles. How an Italian-led team is proposing a new standard for custom luxury homes in Southern California.

The insurance dimension of fire-resistant home design

As major insurers retreat from California, how is non-combustible construction changing the conversation around coverage, premiums and long-term property value?

A new model for bespoke ultra-luxury villas

How MyVilla's orchestration model — assembling pre-selected international specialists with local California partners — differs from the traditional developer or architect-led custom home process.

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Interviews, background briefings and press images available upon request.